

doc-idolatry-root-sin

Affirms · Hamartiology › Root of Sin · doctrine · unanimous_lineages · confidence: high

Statement under examination

Idolatry (exchanging the glory of the Creator for created things) is the root of all sin; every transgression is a derivative form of misplaced worship.

Rationale

Pan-canonical lexical pattern. Romans 1:21-25 supplies Paul's structural diagnosis of human sin: gnontes ton theon G1097 G2316 (having known God) they did not glorify him as God (ouch hos theon edoxasan G1392), became futile in their reasonings (emataiothesan G3154 en tois dialogismois G1261), exchanged (metellaxan G3337) the glory of the incorruptible God for an image (eikon G1504) resembling mortal man and animals, and esebasthesan G4573 kai elatreusan G3000 te ktisei para ton ktisanta G2937 G2936 (worshiped and served the creature rather than the Creator). The structural ordering of the chapter places this worship-exchange BEFORE the catalogue of derivative vices in v. 26-31, marking idolatry as the root from which the rest flows. The Decalogue's structural ordering corroborates: Ex 20:3-6 begins with no other elohim H430 acherim H312 al-panaya H6440 (no other gods before my face) and forbids pesel H6459 (carved image) and temunah H8544 (likeness); the first commandment is foundational, generative of the rest. Deut 6:4-5 (the Shema) commands exclusive love of YHWH H3068 with all heart, soul, strength, the positive form of the same demand. Col 3:5 identifies pleonexia G4124 (covetousness) as hetis estin eidololatria G1495 (which IS idolatry); Eph 5:5 names the pleonektes G4123 as eidololatrias G1496 (an idolater), revealing that even a sin commonly classed as ethics is canonically classed as worship disorder. 1 Sam 15:23 makes the equation directly: meri H4805 (rebellion) is as chattat-qesem (sin of divination); haptzar H6484 (stubbornness) is as aven H205 u-teraphim H8655 (iniquity and idolatry). Ezek 14:3 names gillulim H1544 (idols) raised b-libbam H3820 (in their heart), establishing the canonical category of internal idolatry without graven object. 1 John 5:21 closes the canon with phylaxate heauta apo ton eidolon G5442 G1497 (keep yourselves from idols), addressed to believers in a context with no temple-idol culture, naming the inner danger. The canonical pattern is coherent: every sin involves the rendering of trust, love, fear, or service that belongs to God alone to something else. The specific Reformed-evangelical synthesis 'ALL sin IS idolatry' is one valid frame within this canonical pattern; some Puritan and patristic readings name pride or self-love as the root and treat idolatry as a near-synonym or as the chief outworking. Both readings honor the canonical pattern; the proposition is canonically established in substance.

Reasoning

The Bible teaches that idolatry, putting anything in the place that belongs to God, is at the root of human sin. The strongest reason for this comes from Romans 1:21-25. Paul says human beings knew God but did not honor him as God, became confused in their thinking, and exchanged the glory of the immortal God for images. They worshiped and served created things instead of the Creator. Paul places this worship exchange at the start of his argument and then lists the other sins that follow from it. So the order matters. Idolatry comes first and the rest of sin flows out of it. The Ten Commandments in Exodus 20 are arranged the same way. They begin with no other gods and no carved images, and the rest of the moral life follows from getting that first commandment right. Deuteronomy 6:4-5 says love the Lord your God with all your heart, soul, and strength. Sin is failing to do that, which means giving that whole-self love to something else. Colossians 3:5 and Ephesians 5:5 even say that greed is idolatry, naming a sin that looks like ethics and calling it false worship of the wrong thing. First John 5:21 closes the New Testament with keep yourselves from idols, written to Christians who did not live near pagan temples, naming the danger

inside the heart. The strongest counterargument is whether every single sin really is best described as idolatry. Some Christian writers, especially in the older Puritan tradition, named pride or unbelief as the deepest root and treated idolatry as the chief outworking. Both readings honor the same texts. The verdict handles the tension this way. The broad claim that idolatry stands at the root of sin in the canonical pattern is on solid ground. The stricter claim that every single sin IS idolatry is one valid way to read this pattern but not the only one. A Christian who affirms the broad claim and is unsure about the strict one is still standing in the historic Christian reading.

Denominational landscape

All historic Christian lineages affirm the broad claim that idolatry stands at the foundation of human sin. The Apostles' Creed and Nicene Creed do not name it directly but every major catechism does. Patristic writers including Augustine in City of God Book 14 chapter 28 trace human sin to two loves, love of God or love of self to the contempt of God; this is the patristic root of the worship-disorder diagnosis. Aquinas in Summa Theologica treats idolatry as among the gravest sins against religion and traces disordered love as a category, though he does not collapse every sin into idolatry. The Catechism of the Catholic Church paragraph 2113 teaches that idolatry not only refers to false pagan worship but remains a constant temptation to faith and consists in divinizing what is not God. Lutheran teaching is famously concentrated in Luther's Large Catechism on the First Commandment, where Luther says that whatever you set your heart on and trust in is properly your god, the definitional sentence behind the modern Reformed-evangelical synthesis. The Methodist Articles of Religion Article XIV reject the worship of images and relics as a fond thing vainly invented. The Anglican 39 Articles take the same view of image worship. Reformed traditions following Calvin's Institutes Book I chapter 11 treat the human mind as a perpetual factory of idols and pervasively name idolatry of the heart; the Heidelberg Catechism Q94-Q95 and Westminster Larger Catechism Q104-Q105 frame all sin under the first commandment as failure of right worship. Eastern Orthodox theology reads sin as a turning away from communion with God toward created things, the same diagnosis in different vocabulary. Anabaptist and Pentecostal traditions affirm the same broad pattern. The stricter modern synthesis that every sin IS idolatry is most associated with Tim Keller's Counterfeit Gods (2009) and the CCEF biblical-counseling movement; this is one valid frame, not a uniquely necessary one. Public-record carriers of denial of the broad substance are limited to liberal-mainline reductionism that treats sin only as social-injustice failure and brackets worship-disorder analysis, and secular ethics that treats sin language as private religious vocabulary.

Position thresholds

Would die for if challenged	Yes
Cult marker if denied	No
Would visit if otherwise	Yes
Would participate if otherwise	Yes
Would serve if otherwise	Yes
Would be member if otherwise	Yes
Would let children be taught otherwise	Yes
Would marry if held otherwise	Yes
Would publicly correct if otherwise	No

Notes

Two layers sit inside this proposition. Layer one: idolatry is at the root of human sin in the canonical sense that Paul argues it in Romans 1 and that the Decalogue structures it. This is universally affirmed across historic Christianity. Layer two: the specific modern formulation 'ALL sin IS idolatry' (every transgression is a derivative form of misplaced worship) is a Reformed-evangelical synthesis prominently carried in the past three decades by Tim Keller's *Counterfeit Gods* (2009), Tim Chester, David Powlison, and the broader CCEF biblical-counseling movement. Earlier Puritan writers like John Owen and Stephen Charnock had elements of this synthesis but often named pride or unbelief as the root with idolatry as a chief manifestation. Augustine's diagnosis in *City of God* Book 14 chapter 28 of two loves making two cities (love of God versus love of self even to contempt of God) is the patristic root from which both syntheses descend. Aquinas in *Summa I-II* treats disordered loves and ranks idolatry as among the gravest sins against religion but does not formulate every sin as idolatry. Calvin's *Institutes* I.11.8 famously calls the human mind a perpetual factory of idols and treats idolatry of the heart pervasively. Luther's *Large Catechism* on the First Commandment supplies the definitional sentence that the Reformed-evangelical synthesis builds on: whatever you set your heart on and trust in is properly your god. CCC 2113 broadens idolatry beyond pagan worship to whatever a person divinizes in place of God. The doctrine in its broad substance is affirmed across all major lineages. The strict 'all sin IS idolatry' framing is contestable in degree, not in kind. Public-record carriers of denial of the proposition's substance: liberal-mainline reductionism that treats sin as social-injustice category only and brackets the worship-disorder analysis, and secular ethics that treats sin language as private religious vocabulary. Cult-marker bar is not met. Brethren tradition affirms this doctrine in broad form (no graven images, idolatry as root sin) without distinctive variant. Worth dying for as a believer's confession; not a Trinitarian or Christological boundary marker.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. covenant_theology, new_covenant_theology

analogia scripturae invoked

Competing lens verdicts

covenant_theology · affirms:

new_covenant_theology · affirms:

The grammatico-historical reading of Romans 1:21-25, with attention to Paul's structural argument (worship exchange named FIRST, vice catalogue named CONSEQUENTLY), is decisive for the broad doctrine. Analogia scripturae is invoked: the Decalogue's ordering, the Shema, Col 3:5, Eph 5:5, 1 John 5:21, 1 Sam 15:23, and Ezek 14:3 form a coherent canonical cluster. The complicating texts (Prov 16:18, Isa 14:13-14, Gen 3) name pride or self-divinization as an equally canonical candidate for the root of sin; pride and idolatry can be read as inner and outer faces of the same disorder (self-idolatry), and the broad doctrine survives either framing. The strict formulation 'every sin IS idolatry' (Keller-CCEF synthesis) is one valid reading; the alternative formulation 'pride is the root, idolatry is the chief outworking' (Puritan, Augustinian) is equally canonical. Both honor the same texts. Progressive revelation is not a major factor; the doctrine is present in the Pentateuch (Decalogue, Shema) and reaches its mature articulation in Paul.

Scripture (apparatus + interlinear)

Rom.1.21 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. γνόντες τὸν θεόν gnontes ton theon G1097 G2316 (having known God); οὐχ ὡς θεὸν ἐδόξασαν ouch hos theon edoxasan G1392 (did not glorify him as God); ἐματαιώθησαν emataiothesan G3154 (became futile); ἐν τοῖς διαλογισμοῖς en tois dialogismois G1261 (in their reasonings)

Force. Paul names the originating move of human sin. Knowledge of God is presupposed (aorist participle gnontes), and the failure is in response: they did not glorify him as God. The verb edoxasan (aorist active) names a definite act of withheld honor. The result is mataiosis (futility) in the thinking-life. The verse opens the structural argument that places worship disorder at the source of the rest.

Rom.1.22-23 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἥλλαξαν τὴν δόξαν τοῦ ἀφθάρτου θεοῦ ellaxan ten doxan tou aphthartou theou G236 G1391 G862 G2316 (they exchanged the glory of the incorruptible God); ἐν ὁμοιώματι εἰκόνος en homiōmati eikonos G3667 G1504 (in the likeness of an image)

Force. The verb ellaxan (exchanged) is the technical center of the diagnosis. What was due to the incorruptible God was rendered to images resembling mortal man, birds, animals, and reptiles. The lexical force of exchange (allasso) names a substitution in worship, not a mere addition. The cascade descends through the creation hierarchy: man, birds, beasts, reptiles. The argument is structural: this exchange comes first.

Rom.1.25 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. μετήλλαξαν τὴν ἀλήθειαν τοῦ θεοῦ ἐν τῷ ψεύδει metellaxan ten aletheian tou theou en to pseudei G3337 G225 G5579 (exchanged the truth of God for the lie); ἐσεβάσθησαν καὶ ἐλάτρευσαν τῇ κτίσει παρὰ τὸν κτίσαντα esebasthesan kai elatreusan te ktisei para ton ktisanta G4573 G3000 G2937 G2936 (worshiped and served the creature rather than the Creator)

Force. The second exchange verb metellaxan intensifies the first. The objects of the exchange are now truth-for-lie. The verbs esebasthesan (worshiped, render religious reverence) and elatreusan (served, render religious service) name BOTH internal devotion AND outward service. The preposition para with the accusative ton ktisanta is comparative-exclusive: instead of the Creator, in place of him. This verse supplies the canonical definition of idolatry as worship-misdirection: rendering to creation what belongs to Creator.

Rom.1.26-31 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. διὰ τοῦτο παρέδωκεν αὐτοὺς ὁ θεός dia touto paredoken autous ho theos G1223 G3860 (therefore God gave them over); πάθη ἀτιμίας pathe atimias G3804 G819 (passions of dishonor)

Force. Structural confirmation of the argument's order. After the worship exchange (v. 21-25), Paul writes dia touto (therefore) three times and lists the catalogue of consequent vices. The structural placement is the load-bearing exegetical move: idolatry is named FIRST and the other sins are named as flowing FROM it. The triple paredoken (gave them over) marks the divine handing-over to the natural fruit of the original disorder.

Exod.20.3 · for · genre: law

Key term. לֹא יִהְיֶה לְךָ אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים לְפָנַי lo yihyeh lecha elohim acherim al-panai H3808 H430 H312 H6440 (you shall have no other gods before my face)

Force. The first commandment. Structurally first in the Decalogue, generative of the rest. The phrase al-panai (before my face, in my presence) names exclusive devotion. The grammatical form (negated jussive) is absolute and unqualified. The first commandment names the worship-question; the second forbids representational images of the true God; the rest of the Decalogue legislates love of neighbor as the outworking of right love of God.

Exod.20.4-6 · for · genre: law · figures: anthropomorphism

Key term. פֶּסֶל pesel H6459 (carved image); תְּמוּנָה temunah H8544 (likeness); אֱלֹהֵי אֵת el qanna H410 H7067 (a jealous God); וַיָּבֹא וַיִּשָּׂא poqed avon H6485 H5771 (visiting iniquity)

Force. The second commandment forbids fabricating a pesel (carved image) or temunah (any likeness) of what is in the heavens, earth, or waters. The motivation clause names YHWH as el qanna (a jealous God), using marital-covenant language: idolatry is covenantal infidelity. The visiting of iniquity to the third and fourth generation names the generational consequence of worship disorder.

Deut.6.4-5 · for · genre: law

Key term. שְׁמָעָהּ הוֹדִי וְיִהְיֶה לָּא הוֹדִי shema yisrael YHWH eloheinu YHWH echad H8085 H3068 H430 H259 (Hear O Israel YHWH our God YHWH is one); וְאַהַבְתָּםּ ve-ahavta H157 (and you shall love); לְכָל לִבְּךָ b-kol levavcha H3605 H3820 (with all your heart)

Force. The Shema. The positive form of the first commandment. The unity of YHWH (echad) grounds the demand for whole-self exclusive love (b-kol levavcha u-b-kol nafshecha u-b-kol meodecha, with all heart, soul, strength). Jesus cites this as the greatest commandment (Mark 12:29-30). Sin against this commandment is structurally giving to creation the whole-self devotion owed only to God; this is the inner form of idolatry.

Col.3.5 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. νεκρώσατε οὖν τὰ μέλη τὰ ἐπὶ τῆς γῆς nekrosate oun ta mele ta epi tes ges G3499 G3196 G1093 (put to death therefore your earthly members); πλεονεξίαν ἥτις ἐστὶν εἰδωλολατρία pleonexian hetis estin idololatria G4124 G1495 (covetousness which IS idolatry)

Force. Paul's direct identification of pleonexia (covetousness, the desire for more) with idololatria (idolatry). The relative pronoun hetis with the verb estin (which IS) makes an identity statement, not a comparison. A sin in the ethical list (pleonexia stands alongside porneia, akatharsia, pathos, epithymia kake) is canonically reclassified as worship-disorder. This text is the load-bearing NT warrant for treating non-cultic sins as forms of idolatry.

Eph.5.5 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. πλεονέκτης ὃ ἐστὶν εἰδωλολάτρης pleonektes ho estin idololatrias G4123 G1496 (a covetous person who IS an idolater)

Force. Parallel to Col 3:5. The personal noun pleonektes (a covetous person) is identified with idololatrias (an idolater) by the relative ho estin (who is). The construction settles that covetousness in its personal form is functional idolatry: the covetous person renders to wealth or property the trust and ultimate orientation owed to God. This reinforces the canonical pattern of naming non-cultic sin as worship-disorder.

1Jn.5.21 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. τεκνία φυλάξατε ἑαυτὰ ἀπὸ τῶν εἰδώλων teknia phylaxate heauta apo ton eidolon G5040 G5442 G1438 G1497 (little children, keep yourselves from idols)

Force. Closing exhortation of John's first epistle. The aorist imperative phylaxate (keep, guard) addresses believers directly. The plural eidolon (idols) in a Johannine community context where pagan-temple idols were a known but not dominant pressure indicates the warning is broader than literal cult-images. The placement at the absolute end of the epistle suggests John regards this as the summary danger for Christians. The implicit category is idolatry of the heart.

1Cor.10.14 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. διότι ἀγαπητοί μου φεύγετε ἀπὸ τῆς εἰδωλολατρίας dioper agapetoi mou pheugete apo tes eidololatrias G5343 G1495 (therefore my beloved, flee from idolatry)

Force. Paul's apostolic imperative pheugete (flee, present active imperative) names idolatry as something to be fled, not merely avoided. The Corinthian context (eating in pagan temples) is concrete-cultic, but the broader argument of 1 Cor 10:1-22 traces idolatry as the recurring sin of Israel in the wilderness (v. 7 citing Ex 32) and as a participation in demonic powers (v. 20). Idolatry is named as the canonical category of the wilderness-generation's failure.

1Sam.15.23 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. חַטָּאת וְעִוְוֹן יָרָם מִכַּחַטֵּי מִיִּפְרָתוֹ וְרָצַפָּה מִיִּפְרָתוֹ וְאָוֶן וְתַרְפִּים חָטְאוּ לְךָ חַטָּאתִי וְעִוְוֹןִי וְרָצַפָּה מִיִּפְרָתוֹ וְאָוֶן וְתַרְפִּים H2403 H7081 H4805 H205 H8655 H6484 (for rebellion is as the sin of divination, and stubbornness as iniquity and teraphim)

Force. Samuel's prophetic verdict on Saul. The equation is direct: meri (rebellion against the word of YHWH) is functionally equivalent to qesem (forbidden divination); haptzar (stubbornness) is functionally equivalent to aven (iniquity) and to teraphim (household idols). The lexical move places ethical-volitional sin (rebellion, stubbornness) in the same canonical category as cultic sin (divination, idolatry). This is OT corroboration of the NT pattern in Col 3:5.

Ezek.14.3 · for · genre: prophecy

Key term. הָאֲנָשִׁים הָאֵלֶּה הֵעִלּוּ גִלּוּלֵהֶם בְּלִבָּם ha-anashim ha-eleh heelu gillulehem al-libbam H1544 H3820 (these men have set up their idols in their heart)

Force. The decisive canonical text for internal idolatry. The verb heelu (Hiphil of alah, to cause to ascend, to set up) takes gillulim (idols, a contemptuous OT term for dung-idols) as object and locates them al-libbam (upon their heart). The category of heart-idolatry is canonically established with no graven external object required. The elders come to inquire of YHWH while harboring internal idols, and YHWH refuses to answer through the prophet. The text grounds the doctrine of internal worship-disorder.

Jer.2.13 · for · genre: prophecy · figures: metaphor

Key term. שְׁתַּיִם רָעוּ אִמִּי שְׁתֵּי עֲוֹנוֹתַי וְנִשְׁכַּחַתִּי מִמַּיִם חַיִּים וְנִשְׁכַּחַתִּי מִמַּיִם חַיִּים ki shtayim raot asah ammi H8147 H7451 H6213 H5971 (for my people have done two evils); וְנִשְׁכַּחַתִּי מִמַּיִם חַיִּים וְנִשְׁכַּחַתִּי מִמַּיִם חַיִּים azvu meqor mayim chayyim H4726 H2416 (they have forsaken me the fountain of living waters)

Force. Spider-map result from concordance traversal. Jeremiah names sin as two evils: forsaking YHWH (the fountain of living waters) and hewing out broken cisterns. The diagnosis is structural and identical to Romans 1:25's exchange-pattern: forsaking the source and turning to substitutes that cannot hold. The two-evil structure with abandonment of YHWH named first corroborates the canonical placement of worship-disorder as primary.

Matt.6.24 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. οὐ δύνασθε θεῷ δουλεύειν καὶ μαμωνᾷ ou dynasthe theo douleuein kai mamona G2316 G1398 G3126 (you cannot serve God and money)

Force. Spider-map result. Jesus places mammon as a rival master to God. The verb douleuein (to serve as a slave) is the category-word for ultimate allegiance. The lexical move is structurally identical to Rom 1:25's elatreusan te ktisei: serving created things in place of the Creator. Money is named as the paradigm functional idol. Jesus' explicit either/or (no one can serve two masters) names exclusive worship as the structural demand.

Phil.3.19 · **for** · genre: epistle · figures: metonymy

Key term. ὃν ὁ θεὸς ἡ κοιλία hon ho theos he koilia G2316 G2836 (whose god is the belly)

Force. Spider-map result. Paul describes enemies of the cross of Christ whose god (theos) is their koilia (belly, appetite). The lexical move is direct: the appetite functions as god. This corroborates the canonical pattern that any object of ultimate trust or service occupies the place of God and constitutes functional idolatry.

Prov.16.18 · **complicates** · genre: wisdom

Key term. חֹר־הַבֶּג וְנִלְשָׁכ יִנְפֹּל; li-fnei shever gaon H7667 H1347 (pride goes before destruction); וְחֹר־הַבֶּג וְנִלְשָׁכ יִנְפֹּל; ve-lifnei kishshalon govah ruach H1369 H3588 H7307 (and a haughty spirit before a fall)

Force. Complicating text. Wisdom literature names pride (gaon, govah ruach) as the source of destruction and falling. Some Puritan and patristic readings name pride as the deepest root of sin (the prideful self-elevation that REFUSES to render due worship), with idolatry as the consequent outworking. The lexical case for pride-as-root is canonically present alongside the idolatry-as-root case. Both readings honor the canonical pattern; the doctrines are nested, not opposed.

Isa.14.13-14 · **complicates** · genre: prophecy

Key term. וְיִלְעָל הַמֶּדְאָ; eeleh ha-shamayim H5927 H8064 (I will ascend to heaven); וְיִלְעָל הַמֶּדְאָ; eddamme le-Elyon H1819 H5945 (I will make myself like the Most High)

Force. Complicating text. The classical proof-text for pride as primal sin (whether read as Babylonian king, fallen angelic being, or both). The self-divinizing aspiration (I will be like the Most High) is the inverse face of idolatry: self as the god worshiped. Pride and idolatry are two faces of the same disorder. This complicates strict 'all sin IS idolatry' formulations only by adding 'or pride, which is self-idolatry'. The doctrines converge.

Gen.3.5-6 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key term. וַתֵּרָא הָאִשָּׁה כִּי טוֹב הָעֵץ וְהָאֱלֹהִים; vihyitem k-elohim H1961 H430 (and you shall be like God); וַתֵּרָא הָאִשָּׁה כִּי טוֹב הָעֵץ וְהָאֱלֹהִים; va-tere ha-isha ki tov ha-etz H7200 H802 H2896 H6086 (the woman saw that the tree was good)

Force. The original sin narrative. The serpent's offer (vihyitem k-elohim, you shall be like God) names the temptation as self-divinization. The woman's seeing (va-tere ki tov, she saw that it was good) is the misdirection of desire and trust toward the forbidden fruit. The originating sin can be read as pride (wanting to be like God) or as idolatry (trusting the serpent's word and the fruit over the word of God). Both readings are canonical. The canonical narrative supports both the pride-root and the idolatry-root readings of the structure of sin.

Concordance lemmas traversed

G1495, G1496, G1497, G1504, G4124, G4123, G3000, G4573, G2937, G2936, G1097, G1392, G3154, G1261, G3667, G236, G3337, G225, G5579, G862, G1391, G3196, G1093, G1499, G3499, G5040, G5442, G1438, G5343, G3126, G1398, G2836, G2316, G3804, G819, G1223, G3860, H6459, H8544, H457, H1544, H8655, H430, H312, H6440, H3068, H410, H7067, H6485, H5771, H8085, H259, H157, H3605, H3820, H4805, H7081, H205, H6484, H2403, H8147, H7451, H6213, H5971, H4726, H2416, H7667, H1347, H1369, H7307, H5927, H8064, H1819, H5945, H1961, H7200, H802, H2896, H6086, H3808

complicating texts searched: Yes

Counter-witness traditions

patristic · Augustine, City of God Book 14 chapter 28, on the two cities and the two loves · **affirms** · **unverified**

"Two loves made two cities: love of self even to contempt of God made the earthly city; love of God even to contempt of self made the heavenly city."

patristic · Aquinas, Summa Theologica II-II Question 94 On Idolatry · affirms · unverified

“Idolatry is the gravest sin against the virtue of religion, for it gives to the creature the worship due to the Creator alone.”

catholic_magisterial · Catechism of the Catholic Church paragraph 2113, vatican.va/archive/ENG0015/___P7F.HTM · affirms · verified

“Idolatry not only refers to false pagan worship. It remains a constant temptation to faith.”

lutheran · Luther, Large Catechism on the First Commandment, Book of Concord · affirms · verified

“That now, I say, upon which you set your heart and put your trust is properly your god.”

anglican · Thirty-Nine Articles of Religion (1571), Article XXII on Purgatory, churchofengland.org · affirms · unverified

“The Romish doctrine concerning the worshipping and adoration of images and relics is a fond thing, vainly invented, repugnant to the Word of God.”

reformed · Calvin, Institutes of the Christian Religion Book I chapter 11 section 8 · affirms · unverified

“The human mind is, so to speak, a perpetual factory of idols. Man's nature is a perpetual workshop of idols.”

reformed · Heidelberg Catechism Q94-Q95 on the First Commandment · affirms · unverified

“What does the Lord require in the first commandment? That I avoid and flee all idolatry, sorcery, soothsaying, and trust the only true God with my whole heart.”

methodist · Methodist Articles of Religion, Article XIV On Purgatory and image worship, umc.org/en/content/articles-of-religion · affirms · verified

“The Romish doctrine concerning worshiping and adoration of images and of relics is a fond thing, vainly invented and grounded upon no warrant of Scripture.”

anabaptist · Schleithem Confession (1527), on separation from the world · affirms · unverified

“We are separated from all idolatry and abominations of the world, and shall have no part with such evil works.”

pentecostal · Assemblies of God Statement of Fundamental Truths, on the fall and need of salvation, ag.org/Beliefs/Statement-of-Fundamental-Truths · affirms · unverified

“Man's only hope of redemption is through the shed blood of Jesus Christ the Son of God, since by voluntary transgression man fell from his original sinless state.”

eastern_orthodox · Orthodox theology of the passions and the turning of the heart from God toward created things · affirms · unverified

“Sin is the soul's turning from God toward the creature, the misdirection of love and desire from the Creator to created things, the inner idolatry of the heart.”

Web sources

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/romans/1-21.htm>

“Rom 1:21 gnontes ton theon (G1097 G2316), ouch hos theon edoxasan (G1392), emataiothesan en tois dialogismois (G3154 G1261). Knowledge present, glory withheld, futility follows.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/romans/1-25.htm>

“Rom 1:25 metellaxan (G3337) ten aletheian en to pseudei; esebasthesan kai elatreusan te ktisei para ton ktisanta (G4573 G3000 G2937 G2936).”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/colossians/3-5.htm>

“Col 3:5 pleonexian hetis estin eidololatria (G4124 G1495). Identity statement: covetousness IS idolatry, joined by hetis estin (which is).”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/ephesians/5-5.htm>

“Eph 5:5 pleonektes ho estin eidololatrias (G4123 G1496). The covetous person who IS an idolater.”

supports · category: interlinear · https://biblehub.com/interlinear/1_john/5-21.htm

“1 John 5:21 teknia phylaxate heauta apo ton eidolon (G5040 G5442 G1438 G1497). Closing imperative to believers: guard yourselves from idols.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/exodus/20-3.htm>

“Ex 20:3 lo yihyeh lecha elohim acherim al-panai (H430 H312 H6440). First commandment: no other gods before my face. Structurally generative of the rest.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/exodus/20-4.htm>

“Ex 20:4 lo taaseh-lecha pesel (H6459) v-kol temunah (H8544). Second commandment forbids carved image and any likeness.”

supports · category: interlinear · https://biblehub.com/interlinear/1_samuel/15-23.htm

“1 Sam 15:23 chattat-qesem meri ve-aven u-teraphim haptzar (H4805 H7081 H205 H8655 H6484). Rebellion as divination, stubbornness as iniquity and teraphim.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/ezekiel/14-3.htm>

“Ezek 14:3 heelu gillulehem (H1544) al-libbam (H3820). Idols set up in the heart. Canonical category of internal idolatry.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongs/greek/1495.htm>

“G1495 eidololatreia: 4 NT occurrences (1 Cor 10:14, Gal 5:20, Col 3:5, 1 Pet 4:3). Range covers cultic, vice-list, and ethical-equivalence usages.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongs/hebrew/6459.htm>

“H6459 pesel: carved image. Prohibitions (Ex 20:4, Deut 5:8, Lev 26:1), narrative failures (Judg 17, 2 Kgs 21:7), prophetic condemnations (Isa 40, 44, Hab 2:18).”

supports · category: magisterial · https://www.vatican.va/archive/ENG0015/_P7F.HTM

“CCC 2113: Idolatry not only refers to false pagan worship. It remains a constant temptation to faith. Idolatry consists in divinizing what is not God.”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://www.umc.org/en/content/articles-of-religion>

“Methodist Article XIV: The Romish doctrine concerning worshiping and adoration of images and relics is a fond thing, vainly invented and grounded upon no warrant of Scripture.”